

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Security Engineer | Microsoft Sentinel, Microsoft Defender Extended Detection and Response (XDR) and Enterprise Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) Deployments

United Kingdom (Hybrid/Remote) | +44 7403 190750 | prosper.awuni@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/awuniprosper

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Security Engineer with over five years of experience designing, deploying and tuning Microsoft Security platforms at enterprise scale. I specialise in Microsoft Sentinel Security Information and Event Management (SIEM), Microsoft Defender Extended Detection and Response (XDR), Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), with strong proficiency in Kusto Query Language (KQL) for detection engineering and advanced threat hunting. I have led SIEM and Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) implementations across organisations of up to 8,000 users and have experience developing Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks to automate detection and response workflows. I am skilled at mentoring junior engineers and delivering structured security improvements aligned to the MITRE ATT&CK framework. I am seeking a remote senior security engineering role where I can lead large-scale Microsoft XDR and Sentinel deployment projects and provide expert guidance to clients on detection and response capabilities.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Microsoft Sentinel SIEM:** KQL detection rules; analytics rules; workbooks; automation playbooks (Logic Apps); SOAR; data connectors; log ingestion and tuning
- **Microsoft Defender XDR:** Defender for Endpoint (MDE); Defender for Identity (MDI); Microsoft 365 Defender; extended detection and response across endpoint, identity and email
- **Identity and Cloud Security:** Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory (AD)); Conditional Access; Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA); Single Sign-On (SSO); Microsoft Intune; Azure security services
- **Additional EDR and SIEM:** CrowdStrike Falcon (Next-Generation SIEM, EDR, Prevent, Insight, Discover); Splunk with Search Processing Language (SPL)
- **Incident Response and Threat Hunting:** NIST 800-61 incident response lifecycle; MITRE ATT&CK mapping; digital forensics support; threat hunting; alert triage
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io; Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS); AppCheck; Nessus; remediation tracking and reporting
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell; KQL; Python (basic); SOAR automation development
- **Privileged Access Management:** BeyondTrust PAM; least-privilege enforcement; privileged session monitoring
- **Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF); CIS Controls; ISO 27001; Cyber Essentials+; MITRE ATT&CK

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL) - Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

March 2025 - Present

- Architect and maintain Microsoft Sentinel SIEM at enterprise scale across an 8,000-user estate, including data connector configuration, analytics rule development in KQL, workbooks and SOAR automation playbooks via Logic Apps
- Engineer and tune Microsoft Defender XDR, including Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Defender for Identity (MDI), delivering integrated extended detection and response across endpoint and identity attack surfaces
- Lead end-to-end incident response aligned to NIST 800-61, from initial triage through containment, eradication and post-incident review, mapping threat activity to the MITRE ATT&CK framework
- Administer and optimise CrowdStrike Falcon platform including NG-SIEM, EDR, Prevent, Insight and Discover across the full user estate, maintaining high-fidelity detection coverage
- Develop KQL-based detection rules and hunting queries in Microsoft Sentinel to identify advanced threats, reducing analyst alert fatigue through precision tuning and noise reduction
- Design and implement SOAR automation in Microsoft Sentinel using Logic Apps, automating phishing triage, account compromise response and threat intelligence enrichment workflows

- Configure Microsoft Entra ID Conditional Access policies, MFA and SSO integrations to enforce Zero Trust identity controls across cloud and hybrid environments
- Conduct advanced threat hunting using CrowdStrike Falcon and Microsoft Sentinel, proactively identifying indicators of compromise and adversary tradecraft mapped to MITRE ATT&CK
- Mentor and support junior security analysts, reviewing their detection work and providing guidance on SIEM rule development, incident handling and platform administration
- Lead vulnerability management using Pentera BAS and Tenable.io, coordinating remediation activities with IT teams and reporting progress to senior stakeholders

University of the Arts, London (UAL) - Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

- Deployed, configured and maintained Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) and Microsoft 365 Defender across the 8,000-user estate, establishing integrated XDR coverage
- Authored and maintained KQL detection rules and analytics rules in Microsoft Sentinel, aligned to MITRE ATT&CK tactics and techniques
- Triaged and investigated security alerts within Microsoft Sentinel SIEM and CrowdStrike Falcon EDR, performing root cause analysis and driving incidents to resolution
- Supported SOAR playbook development to automate repetitive alert handling tasks, reducing manual analyst effort and improving response consistency
- Maintained Microsoft Entra ID Conditional Access and MFA configurations, enforcing identity security controls across cloud and on-premise systems
- Conducted vulnerability scanning using Nessus and AppCheck, producing prioritised remediation reports and tracking findings to closure
- Assisted with security awareness training and phishing simulation programmes, contributing to reduced user susceptibility to social engineering attacks

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) - IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

- Deployed and configured CrowdStrike Falcon EDR and Microsoft Defender for Endpoint across a cloud-first SaaS and FinTech environment, establishing foundational EDR coverage
- Administered Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory) including MFA, SSO and Conditional Access policies, enforcing least-privilege access principles
- Managed Microsoft Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM) policies to maintain endpoint security baselines across Windows and mobile devices
- Supported security incident triage and response, escalating to senior engineers and documenting findings for post-incident review
- Conducted vulnerability assessments and coordinated remediation activities in line with NIST CSF and CIS Controls frameworks

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Engineered Microsoft Sentinel SIEM and Defender XDR deployment across 8,000 users at UAL, delivering integrated threat detection coverage spanning endpoint, identity and email with custom KQL detection rules mapped to MITRE ATT&CK
- Developed a suite of Microsoft Sentinel SOAR playbooks that automated phishing triage, account compromise containment and threat intelligence enrichment, reducing mean time to respond (MTTR) for high-volume alerts
- Led the deployment of CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and EDR across UAL, enabling real-time threat visibility and automated response for endpoint threats across a diverse estate
- Mentored junior analysts in KQL detection rule development and SIEM operations, improving team capability and reducing dependency on senior engineers for routine detection tasks
- Contributed to Cyber Essentials+ certification at UAL, leading technical evidence collection for endpoint protection, patch management and access control controls

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
-

References available on request | Remote (London/UK)